
LAKE INSTITUTE

English Grammar Homework Packet

Intermediate Level — Grammar Focus



“You are what you read. You are what you practise.”

— Ahsan

Grammar Reference — Study These Rules First

Read through all the rules before starting the exercises. Refer back to this section whenever you are unsure.

Rule 1 — Articles: a / an / the

Use **a** or **an**: for something general or mentioned for the first time.

Use **the**: for something specific, already known, or unique.

Use **nothing** (—): for proper nouns, languages, general ideas.

Situation	Correct	Wrong
First mention	"I saw a dog."	"I saw the dog."
Second mention	" The dog was friendly."	"A dog was friendly."
General / job	"She is a doctor."	"She is doctor."
Proper name	"I study at — Oxford."	"at the Oxford"
Uncountable	"I need — advice."	"I need an advice."

Rule 2 — Prepositions of Time: in / on / at

Preposition	Use for	Examples
in	years, months, seasons, long periods	<i>in 2015, in July, in winter</i>
on	days of the week, specific dates	<i>on Monday, on 5 April</i>
at	exact times, short periods	<i>at 9 o'clock, at noon, at night</i>
×	"I was born <i>on</i> 1995."	"I was born in 1995."
×	"We meet <i>in</i> Monday."	"We meet on Monday."

Rule 3 — Verb Form After "to" (Infinitive)

After these expressions, always use the **base verb (infinitive)**:

want **to** go plan **to** visit
 try **to** understand need **to** practise
 force someone **to** finish opportunity **to** travel

- ×
- "She wants to *going* abroad." "She wants to **go** abroad."
 × "I am trying to *learning*." "I am trying to **learn**."

Rule 4 — Uncountable Nouns (no -s form)

These nouns **never** take a plural -s. They take “some,” “a lot of,” “much” instead of a number.

advice information vocabulary homework knowledge
luggage traffic equipment furniture research

- × “He gave me many ~~advices~~.” “He gave me a lot of **advice**.”
- × “I have two ~~homeworks~~.” “I have some **homework**.”

Rule 5 — “One of the” + Plural Noun

After “one of the,” the noun is **always plural**, but the verb stays **singular**.

- × “One of the ~~student~~ is absent.” “One of the **students** is absent.”
- × “One of the ~~reason~~ I came here. . . ” “One of the **reasons** I came here. . . ”

Rule 6 — “Go + -ing” for Leisure Activities

go **swimming** go **hiking** go **fishing** go **skiing**
 go **shopping** go **running** go **cycling** go **camping**

- × “I go to ~~do~~ swimming on weekends.” “I go **swimming** on weekends.”

Rule 7 — Common Collocations (Fixed Word Pairs)

Some words must go together. These are called **collocations**. Memorise them as pairs.

- × “get married ~~with~~” “get married **to**”
- × “interested ~~about~~” “interested **in**”
- × “depend ~~of~~” “depend **on**”
- × “good ~~in~~ English” “good **at** English”
- × “~~congratulation~~” “**congratulations**” (always plural)

Exercises

Complete all exercises in order. Write your answers on the lines or circle where instructed. Check your work with the Answer Key on the last page.

Exercise 1 — Spot & Correct the Mistake

(15 min)

Each sentence contains **one mistake**. Underline the error and write the correct sentence below it.

1. "My brother got married with a woman he met at university."

2. "She gave me a lot of informations about the new course."

3. "One of the student in my class speaks four languages."

4. "Every summer, we go to do fishing near the lake."

5. "I was born on 1998 in a small town."

6. "He is trying to still finishing his report."

7. "We have a lot of equipments in our laboratory."

8. "Congratulation on your new job! You deserve it."

9. "She is very good in mathematics and science."

10. "I have an opportunity to studying abroad next year."

Exercise 2 — Fill in the Blank: Articles (a / an / the / —)

(10 min)

Fill in the blank with **a**, **an**, **the**, or **—** (nothing).

1. She is _____ architect working for _____ large firm in the city.
2. I bought _____ new laptop yesterday. _____ laptop is very fast.
3. He studied _____ medicine at _____ University of Edinburgh.
4. Could you give me _____ advice about learning languages?
5. _____ traffic was terrible this morning. I was late for work.
6. My father is _____ engineer and my mother is _____ teacher.
7. _____ Nile is the longest river in Africa.
8. I need _____ information about the train schedule.

Exercise 3 — Choose the Correct Preposition

(10 min)

Circle the correct preposition.

1. The conference starts (**in** / **on** / **at**) 9 o'clock sharp.
2. She was promoted (**in** / **on** / **at**) March last year.
3. We have a team meeting (**in** / **on** / **at**) every Friday afternoon.
4. I finished my degree (**in** / **on** / **at**) 2019.
5. The shop opens (**in** / **on** / **at**) the morning and closes (**in** / **on** / **at**) midnight.
6. He was born (**in** / **on** / **at**) a small village in the mountains.
7. Our flight departs (**in** / **on** / **at**) 14 August.
8. I usually feel most productive (**in** / **on** / **at**) the evening.

Exercise 4 — Countable or Uncountable?

(10 min)

Decide whether the noun is used **correctly** (✓) or **incorrectly** (✗). Write the correction if wrong.

No.	Sentence	or ✗	Correction (if needed)
1	"Can you carry these luggages?"	—	_____
2	"She did a lot of research."	—	_____
3	"We need new furnitures for the office."	—	_____
4	"There was heavy traffic on the road."	—	_____
5	"I have three homeworks to complete."	—	_____
6	"His knowledge of history is impressive."	—	_____
7	"They gave us many informations."	—	_____

Exercise 5 — Verb Form Practice

(10 min)

Complete each sentence using the correct form of the verb in brackets.

1. She is planning to _____ (visit) her family in the summer.
2. My manager forced the whole team to _____ (redo) the report.
3. He suggested _____ (take) a short break before the exam.
4. I am trying to _____ (improve) my pronunciation every day.
5. They had a wonderful opportunity to _____ (present) at the conference.
6. Are you interested in _____ (learn) a second language?

7. He needs to _____ (practise) speaking more often.
8. Every summer, the children go _____ (swim) in the sea.

Exercise 6 — Complete with “One of the...”

(5 min)

Rewrite each sentence using “one of the” + the correct plural noun form.

1. “A main challenge is time management.”
→ One of the main _____ is time management.
2. “A big advantage is the location.”
→ One of the biggest _____ is the location.
3. “An important skill is communication.”
→ One of the most important _____ is communication.
4. “A key reason I moved here was the weather.”
→ One of the key _____ I moved here was the weather.

Exercise 7 — Vocabulary: Useful Intermediate Words

(10 min)

Match each word to its definition. Then write one original sentence using any **three** of the words.

No.	Word	Write the matching letter here
1	negotiate	_____
2	jeopardize	_____
3	dedicate	_____
4	neglect	_____
5	evaluate	_____
6	collaborate	_____

Definitions:

- a) to fail to take care of something b) to put something at risk
 c) to discuss in order to reach an agreement d) to work with others towards a goal
 e) to commit time or effort to something f) to assess or judge the quality of something

Your sentences:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Exercise 8 — Speaking Practice: Record Yourself

(20 min)

Use your phone or laptop to record yourself speaking for **3–4 sentences** on each topic. After recording, listen back and check for mistakes in articles, prepositions, and verb forms.

1. **Introduce yourself** — your name, job or studies, where you are from, and one interesting fact about yourself.
2. **Talk about your hobbies** — use: “*I enjoy...*,” “*I am fond of...*,” “*I used to... but now I...*,” “*One of my favourite activities is...*”
3. **Describe your plans for the future** — use: “*I am planning to...*,” “*One of my goals is to...*,” “*I hope to...*”
4. **Talk about a challenge you have faced** — What happened? What did you do? What did you learn?

Teacher’s Tip (Ahsan): Don’t try to translate from your native language. Think directly in English. If you catch yourself translating, stop and restart the sentence. This habit will improve your fluency faster than anything else.

Exercise 9 — Shadowing Technique

(10 min)

Step 1. Search on YouTube: “*BBC Learning English — 6 Minute English*”

Step 2. Pick any episode on a topic you find interesting.

Step 3. Listen to the first 90 seconds **without pausing**.

Step 4. Replay it and **pause after every sentence**. Repeat the sentence out loud.

Step 5. Do this for at least 8–10 sentences.

Reflection — Answer in your notebook:

What topic was the episode about? _____

Write **3 new words or phrases** you heard and their meanings:

1. _____ means: _____

2. _____ means: _____

3. _____ means: _____

Answer Key

Exercise 1 — Spot & Correct the Mistake

1. "My brother got married **to** a woman he met at university."
2. "She gave me a lot of **information** about the new course."
3. "One of the **students** in my class speaks four languages."
4. "Every summer, we go **fishing** near the lake."
5. "I was born **in** 1998 in a small town."
6. "He is **still trying to finish** his report."
7. "We have a lot of **equipment** in our laboratory."
8. "**Congratulations** on your new job!"
9. "She is very good **at** mathematics and science."
10. "I have an opportunity to **study** abroad next year."

Exercise 2 — Articles

1. **an** architect; **a** large firm
2. **a** new laptop; **The** laptop
3. — medicine; **the** University of Edinburgh
4. — advice (uncountable)
5. **The** traffic
6. **an** engineer; **a** teacher
7. **The** Nile (unique, specific)
8. — information (uncountable)

Exercise 3 — Prepositions

1. **at** 2. **in** 3. **on** 4. **in** 5. **in** the morning; **at** midnight 6. **in** 7. **on** 8. **in**

Exercise 4 — Countable or Uncountable

1. ✗ → "Can you carry this **luggage**?"
- 2.
3. ✗ → "We need new **furniture** for the office."
- 4.
5. ✗ → "I have **three pieces of homework** / **a lot of homework** to complete."
- 6.
7. ✗ → "They gave us a lot of **information**."

Exercise 5 — Verb Forms

1. **visit** 2. **redo** 3. **taking** 4. **improve** 5. **present** 6. **learning** 7. **practise** 8. **swimming**

Exercise 6 — One of the...

1. **challenges** 2. **advantages** 3. **skills** 4. **reasons**

Exercise 7 — Vocabulary Matching

- 1 → c 2 → b 3 → e 4 → a 5 → f 6 → d

A Note from Your Teacher — Ahsan

Grammar improves through **consistent, daily practice** — not through cramming. Try to spend just 15 minutes a day on one rule at a time, and you will see real progress within weeks.

The most important things to focus on right now are:

1. **Stop translating** from your native language — think in English.
2. **Articles** (a / an / the) — practise one context at a time.
3. **Uncountable nouns** — memorise the list in Rule 4.
4. **Record yourself speaking** and listen back critically.

Remember: every mistake you notice is a step forward. Bring this completed packet to your next session.

— *Ahsan*